

Book Club: The Ruby Code (Chapter 12) — Talk Moves for Quiet Readers

Grade 4

WIDA 2-3

The Ruby Code

CONTENT OBJECTIVE

Students will be able to identify key events in Chapter 12 and explain how a character responds to a problem using evidence from the text.

LANGUAGE OBJECTIVE

Students will be able to use simple sentences and sentence frames to retell events, describe feelings, and give one piece of text evidence during a partner discussion.

KEY VOCABULARY

chapter

clue

evidence

problem

solution

SENTENCE FRAMES

- 1 In Chapter 12, ____ happened.
- 2 I think ____ because ____.
- 3 The evidence is ____.

LESSON FLOW

1 Warm-Up

Setup: Students enter, books open to Chapter 12, and a quick response routine is posted on the board.

1. Teacher says: "Show me with your fingers: 1 = confused, 2 = okay, 3 = ready." Scan and note who needs support.
2. Do a 2-minute picture/heading walk (or first page skim) of Chapter 12. Teacher points to 2-3 key details and names them using simple language.
3. Students complete a silent "Stop and Jot" on a half-sheet: write 2 words you think will matter in Chapter 12 (in English or home language) and draw a quick symbol.

Debrief: Call on 2 volunteers (or choose 2 cards) to share one word; teacher repeats and writes the word on the board to build the class word bank.

2 Main Activity

Overview: Students read Chapter 12 with built-in stops, then complete a low-prep organizer to capture events, problem, and evidence.

Directions:

1. First read (teacher-supported): Teacher reads aloud 1-2 pages at a time while students track with a finger. Pause and ask yes/no or either/or checks (e.g., "Is this a problem or a solution?").
2. Second read (partner whisper-read): In pairs, students whisper-read the same section. Partner A reads, Partner B points to the words; switch roles each page (or each paragraph for stronger readers).
3. Stop-and-Box organizer (on paper or notebook): Students fill 3 boxes.
 - Box 1: "Important event" (draw + 1 sentence)
 - Box 2: "Problem" (choose from board word bank + 1 sentence)
 - Box 3: "Evidence" (copy 4-8 words from the text or write the page number + 1 sentence)

Differentiation: For WIDA 2, allow drawing + labels and provide a word bank (event, problem, clue, scared, safe, hide, follow). For WIDA 3, require one because sentence and a short copied quote (4-8 words) as evidence.

3 Speaking Activity

Overview: Students use structured roles to share one idea at a time with built-in wait time and optional nonverbal supports.

Setup:

- Give each pair 3 discussion cards (or write on board): Event, Problem, Evidence.
- Partner structure: Partner A speaks for 20 seconds, Partner B points to the page/box and then repeats one key word; switch.

Sample prompts:

- "Tell me one important event. Where is it in the book?"
- "What is the problem in Chapter 12? How does the character feel?"
- "What is your evidence? Show me the words or the page."

Debrief: Do a quick "Say it again" share-out: teacher selects 2 students to share one sentence; teacher asks a classmate to repeat the sentence using the same frame.

4 Exit Ticket

Students show understanding of Chapter 12 with one quick response.

- Option A: Quick written prompt: "In Chapter 12, the problem is _____. The evidence is _____."
- Option B: Draw and label: Draw the most important event. Label 3 things (characters/objects/setting) and write one sentence: "In Chapter 12, _____ happened."

Teacher tip: Collect at the door and sort into 3 piles (clear, developing, confused) to decide who needs a small-group re-read tomorrow.

TEACHER NOTES

- Tip for WIDA 1-2 students: Accept home-language notes, drawing, pointing to the page, and single words. Offer a mini word bank on a sticky note and let them read with you only (choral echo-read 1-2 sentences).
- Tip for WIDA 3+ students: Ask for one because sentence and a short copied quote as evidence; prompt them to add a feeling word (worried, nervous, excited) connected to the event.
- Scaffolding note: Use "Either/Or" questions ("Is it a clue or a distraction?") and "Show me" prompts ("Point to the sentence") to reduce pressure on quiet students while still increasing participation.
- What to watch for: Students confusing event vs. problem, copying random evidence, or staying silent in partners. Fix with quick reteach: model one example using the organizer, then have students practice repeating the frame with one key word changed.